

themselves out. You can take your time . . . months . . . years . . . before making a decision. There is no need to feel rushed.

In fact, the more pressure you are under to make a decision, usually, the more likely you are to lose money. The investment pros want you to make a move. They don't know any better than you do whether investments will go up or down. But they know where they make money—on the churn. They earn commissions based on transactions, not on investment success.

Investment success happens by taking big positions in big trends and leaving them alone for a long time. The last bull market in U.S. stocks, for example, began in August 1982. You could have taken your time. Thought about it. And waited years before you were sure. The bull market ran for 25 years (depending on how you count it).

Likewise, the current bull market in gold began in 1998, with gold hitting a bottom of \$268 per ounce. You could have bided your time for one . . . two . . . three years. Take it easy. Relax. There's no hurry. Big trends take time. And they pay off big, too, for people who are patient enough to let the market tell its story.

Now we're looking at opportunities we think will pay off over the next 30 years. We'll tell you more about them in the next chapter.

But 30 years is far too long for most people. That's the difference between serious Old Money and the rest of it. Old Money takes its time. And it uses the short-term, panicky nature of most investors in order to pick its opportunities.

For example, we've identified one very attractive opportunity. We could invest now and expect to earn three times the performance of the Dow, each year, over the next, say, 20 years. But what's the hurry? There's a better way. Most investors move in and out depending on the latest thing they've read or the most recent TV report. This sends prices rocketing up one month and falling down the next, even though the long-term, big-picture trend and the real value of the company remain unchanged.

Since we're in no hurry, we just wait for the short-termers to give us an irresistible entry price. Why buy at a reasonable price when you can wait for an absurd discount? We've seen good stocks sell for as little as two times earnings. Practically a giveaway. At that price, there is little downside risk left—and an upside that should multiply our wealth over the next two